

handle on their own. Do you really want your child to learn those lessons?

Getting your deadbeat kid out of the basement is tough love at its harshest, but it's truly the only way. Consider this: It's mostly your fault, so you're going to have to suffer some discomfort as well—not just emotionally, but things will have to get a lot worse before they get a lot better. Trust me, in a little while, you'll look back on this time with gratitude. Even Junior will be grateful you did it. But now, this is ripping off a Band-Aid, times a thousand. Keep the deprivations purely financial. Put a dollar value on everything you give and he or she takes—from the toilet paper rolls that will begin to disappear to the gas tank that suddenly needs constant refilling. First thing you have to keep in mind is that this is not a child we're talking about. He or she is an adult, and should be treated as such.

Before you proceed, make sure you're not dealing with a young person suffering from depression, addiction, or mental illness of any kind. If you suspect you are, you must seek professional guidance. Don't hesitate. Also, if deep down you truly don't want your child to leave home, and in fact you enjoy both the company and having something to complain about, be honest with yourself. Just don't come crying to me in a few years when your kid is still living with you, along with a girlfriend and a baby or two, and your savings have been all but depleted.

But if you're sure you're dealing with a general lack of motivation, and you want that adult out of your house, keep reading for tips on what to do next.

10 Steps for Getting Your Kid Out of Your Basement

Your adult child needs you to be a tough parent. He or she just doesn't know it yet, and can't admit it. You, however, are doing nothing short of saving your financial, emotional, and marital health. Nothing is worth jeopardizing those things, certainly not your beloved child's material comfort. Follow these 10 steps to a tee—and in order—and